

WHAT IS A TISANE?

Consumed for their therapeutic properties, as well as their relaxing and rejuvenating aromas, tisanes are infusions of aromatic herbs and plants. Served either hot or cold, they are a delicious alternative to caffeinated beverages.

TEA OR TISANE?

Contrary to popular belief, not all hot herbal beverages can be categorized as tea. Tisanes are often wrongly referred to as “herbal teas,” but as they are not made from the *Camellia sinensis* plant they are not tea in the strict sense. Instead, tisanes use all parts of various other plants—bark, stems, roots, flowers, seeds, fruit, and leaves—to make an infusion. With the exception of yerba mate, tisanes do not contain caffeine.

HEALING POWERS OF TISANES

For centuries, healing tisanes have been used in traditional Chinese medicine and Indian Ayurvedic medicine to treat the symptoms of various health problems. With the growing popularity of tisanes in the West, wellness blends and mixtures that help to detox, calm and relax, induce sleep, or treat cold and flu



BENEFITS OF TISANES

Containing aromatherapeutic properties, tisanes soothe and rejuvenate both body and mind.

symptoms are now widely available in tea stores and supermarkets. In fact, there is probably a blend or infusion available for almost every kind of ailment.

Plants and herbs have a complicated chemistry and may not mix well with conventional medicines, or may aggravate allergies. Always check with your healthcare professional before deciding to make tisanes a part of your healing plan.

THE HERBALIST

Nicholas Culpeper (1616–1654) was an English physician, apothecary, astrologist, and botanist. His *Complete Herbal* book, a compendium of hundreds of tisane ingredients and their medicinal properties, has been used as a reference since it was published. Every known tisane ingredient at the time is detailed with specific instructions to treat ailments. Practicing as a physician in Spitalfields, London, he combined his knowledge of astrology and apothecary to treat his patients. He was considered a radical in his day.

HOME REMEDY

With their natural healing properties, tisanes are easy home remedies for common ailments.